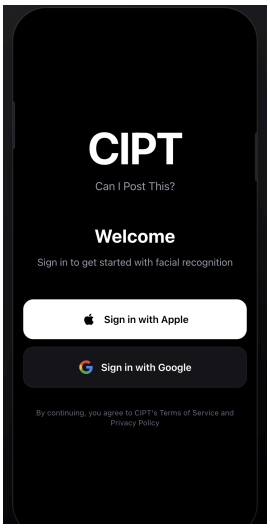
CIPT Report

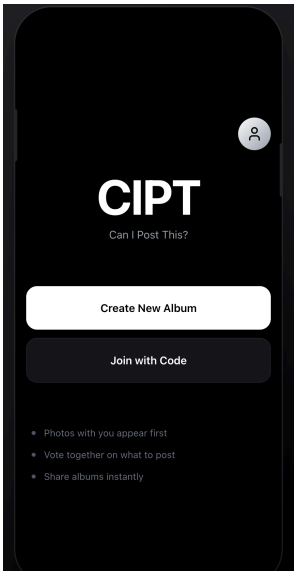
Introduction:

Group photo sharing is a broken system. Especially in large groups, or when taking over 1000 photos for one event, no aspect of the process is built for user needs. Shared albums are annoying to join, you scroll forever and possibly skip over photos you're in, and then everyone is separately sharing in group chats to see what's unanimously liked. It is much more difficult than it should be to see which photos everyone likes and makes it impossible to post them. Time is constantly wasted. Annoyance causes many to hate going through photos overall. There needs to be a solution– and CIPT can be that. CIPT, *Can I Post This?,* replaces the entire workflow with a fast join, download, and approval system.

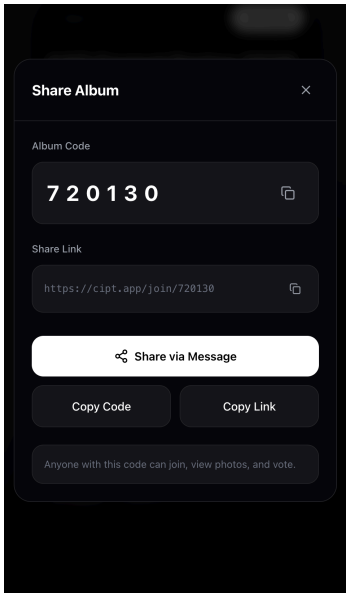
New Product Idea:

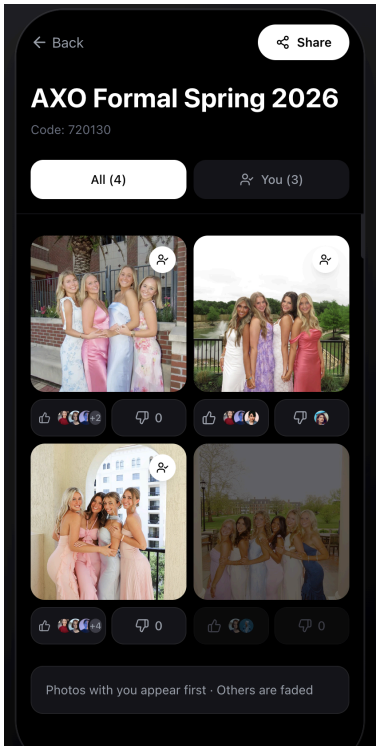


College-aged girls, especially those in sororities, constantly have events where photos are taken en masse to be posted on Instagram, and no sharing platform is built for them. CIPT does not ignore this demographic, but instead prioritizes them.

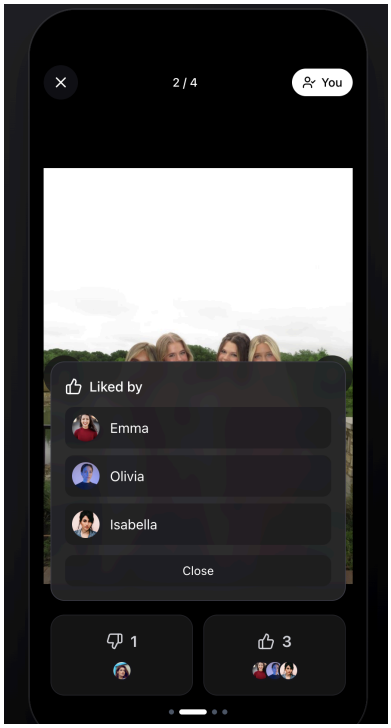


CIPT allows everyone to join albums with a six digit code, eliminating issues of not everyone having each other's number– especially in an age where Snapchat is so prevalent. AI is used to auto detect your face in every photo, based on a facial scan similar to face ID setup, meaning that no one needs to scroll through photos of 100+ other girls to find their own.





You are able to see a tab of your photos, as well as all photos on the album. And each person can like and dislike every photo they are in on the album, streamlining the process of others wanting to post on instagram, and ensuring nothing is posted that not everyone is comfortable with. If



In terms of customer value and satisfaction– CIPT gives instant access and auto-surfaced photos to users, terminates anxiety about bad photos going online, and enables faster posting after events.



This allows everyone to easily click through their photos, instantly see which ones their friends like as well, and post immediately. No more waiting around and back and forth texts. **No more asking ‘Can I post this?”**

Finally, CIPT also works cross-device, meaning Android and Apple users can share photos easily, unlike the competitor of Apple Shared Albums.

Segmentation Strategy and Target Market:

CIPT uses a multi-dimensional approach to segmentation, combining demographic, psychographic, and behavioural segmentation to ensure we identify users to experience the most issues in current group photo sharing systems.

Our demographic segment will include girls aged 18-25, primarily college greek-affiliated students and young adults. This segment is highly active in large gatherings and social events such as formals, parties, vacations, etc. where large volumes of group photos are taken.

Psychographically, CIPT targets individuals who are highly social, image-conscious and highly aware of how they appear on social media, motivated by self-presentation, and accustomed to fast and seamless app experiences. This group puts a high importance on caring how they are seen online and curating their digital footprint.

For behavioural segmentation, we will focus on users who frequently take and post group photos on platforms like Instagram, have experience using shared albums and groups chats for photo sharing and post planning– and experience constant frustration with scrolling through albums, missing photos they are in while saving, and manually requesting to friends if photos are ok to share.

These users are a great example of repeated exposure to the pain points CIPT is designed to eliminate.

The primary target market for CIPT is socially active college girls and young adults who frequently attend group events and want a fast and effortless way to access and manage photos they appear in on social media.

A secondary target market after the brand loyalty is acquired for the primary would include event organisers and wedding photographers who would benefit from an easier way to distribute photos to large groups without needing links or phone numbers. This target market experiences half of the pain points CIPT solves, causing it to be secondary.

This segmentation strategy was chosen because it directly aligns with the core problem CIPT is designed to solve– friction in accessing, finding, and posting photos after social events.

The focus on targeting girls is because most experience this problem at a high frequency compared to others, often dealing with hundreds or even thousands of photos per event. This is even more heightened by the surge of 'picture parties' before events, referencing an hour or two set aside just for group photos.

Existing solutions require users to get links or share phone numbers to join albums, manually scroll through high volumes of irrelevant images, risk missing photos they are in, and face issues knowing which ones are okay with friends to post.

CIPT eliminates access friction with the six digit code, discovery friction by filtering out irrelevant images, and social friction ensuring no one is upset with photos being posted they do not like.

In addition, this target market places a high value on speed and social presentation, making it very likely they will adopt an app that simplifies and improves their experience for a constant situation they are in. By succeeding in adoption and habitual use, CIPT can have viral and permanent growth and use.

Positioning Strategy:

CIPT is a mobile photo-sharing app designed for socially-active young adults that automatically surfaces only the photos a user appears in and enables a shared posting approval function, unlike traditional platforms like Google Photos, Apple Shared Albums, and PhotoCircle, which force users to manually find images they are in and create uncertainty and social tension around sharing. As well as texting photos, which allows liking and replying comments to photos, but has a max of 20 photos per text.

CIPT overcomes these issues by combining

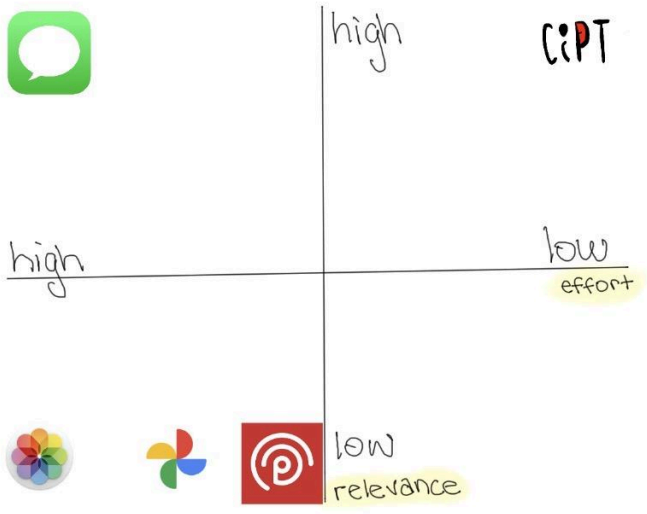
- Automatic photo identification(separating photos the user appears in)
- Structured approval mechanisms(clear thumbs up or down by each person in the photo)
- Simple album sharing(no need for a link or phone number, it is a 6 digit code)

This positions CIPT as a superior alternative that has no competitor having all of these features, and ensuring a seamless and personalised photo-sharing and posting experience.

The positioning map is based on two key dimensions:

- Effort Required: The amount of time and work needed to access, find, and manage photos to post
- Personal Relevance: How likely the photos shown are specifically of the user

Positioning Map:



CIPT is placed at low effort and high relevance because of the ease of joining albums, filtering of photos you are in, and approval function.

iMessage/texting is placed at high relevance but high effort because although the photos will be personally sent and include the user, as well as being able to react and reply to photos, there is a high effort because of personally sending to each person and the 20 photo per text maximum.

Photocircle is placed at medium effort and low relevance because all of the photos are grouped together, however a link is easier to share than the creator of the album having to add each person by phone number.

Google photos is placed at medium/high effort and low relevance because there is no filtering of photos and users find difficulty downloading photos from Google Photos, however the link is easier to join than manually adding.

Finally, Apple Shared Albums are placed at high effort and low relevance because only Apple users can use them, the owner must manually add each user by phone number, and there is no filtering or approval.

It is clear that CIPT will be able to penetrate the market easily based on this positioning map as no other competitor currently covers every aspect of the experience we are creating.

Pricing Strategy:

CIPT will use a freemium model to match competitors and ensure market penetration. The free version of the app will allow users to join albums, see and download photos, and use the like/dislike feature.

For $4 a month we will have a premium version of the app that allows users to exit the app while downloading photos, and they will be able to go to camera roll in the background, as well as a filter feature on the app so photos can be posted directly to Instagram or Facebook– eliminating using the camera roll all together. The direct to Instagram function also means that phone storage is not an issue, as the photos never enter the camera roll.

The logic behind this pricing model is having a low barrier to entry to ensure group and mass adoption, but monetising off of heavy users and users that value speed above all else (the filter function).

Assuming a 5% conversions rate from active users, this premium/freemium model will generate scalable recurring revenue while allowing for mass use with the broader market.

Promotion Strategy:



Our core message:
“Never ask ‘Can I post this?’ again. CIPT instantly shows you the photos you’re in and what your friends approve— so you can post faster, with confidence.”

Sororities constantly have collaborations with brands that include photo opportunities. Right before launch, CIPT will come to sororities at colleges around the country with pop-up matcha stands with “CIPT WITH (insert sorority name)” printed on the cup.

One, it’s a play on words– CIPT = sipped
Two, the girls can take photos at the events and see the app work in real time(in beta mode).

Everyone will be given the code to join an album at the start of the event, with photos being taken the whole time, and afterwards the girls will see exactly how CIPT makes life easier. This will ensure a base amount of people already have the app downloaded and have used it, and will get at minimum a base amount of users before launch. As well as promotion on campus and to followers as they will post with the branded cups.

In addition to the pop-ups, CIPT will select creators in the sororities we visit to post consistent content of how their life has been easier with CIPT through showing events. Such as, “DIML Formal Edition” showing the album being shared, how easy it is to go through, and the post they were able to make. This will help non-users see the new user journey with CIPT and show the value to attract new users to the app.

Conclusion:

Current solutions to group photo sharing like Google Photos, Apple Shared albums, and PhotoCircle focus on storing and sharing large amounts of photos, but do not prioritise the user experience or tailor any functions to a main audience consistently using their products. Users are forced to use multiple platforms, such as moving to text group chats after the full set of photos is picked through, manually add everyone or send links, scroll through hundreds of photos, and then face the entire issue of knowing what is okay to post.

CIPT replaces the entire current workflow, solving all issues in one. We innovate the process by shifting from the album-based model everyone is used to, to adding a personalized album of just you.

The segmentation, positioning, pricing, and promotion strategies all align with a highly socially-conscious target market and a need for speed and confidence in sharing photos. This created an extremely strong market fit and supports rapid adoption within social groups and a viral growth through shared experiences.

CIPT successfully turns a fragmented and frustrating process into a completely seamless and intuitive experience. And, more importantly, ensures no one will ever again need to ask “Can I post this?”

AI Use and Critical Evaluation:

For this project the following tools were used:

Microsoft CoPilot- used for identifying potential competitors

“What are the main competitors to a group photo sharing app for events?”

The main competitors to a group photo sharing app for events are not just other photo apps, but the existing behaviors people rely on:

1. Group messaging apps

Platforms like iMessage, Snapchat, and WhatsApp are the default for sharing photos after events. They are convenient but unorganized, making it difficult to find specific photos later.

2. Shared photo albums

Services such as Apple Photos and Google Photos are designed for group sharing but often involve friction (invites, links) and require users to manually browse large collections.

3. Event-focused camera apps

Apps like Dispo and Lapse focus on capturing moments, but not on efficiently organizing or retrieving photos of specific individuals.

4. Direct sharing tools

Features such as AirDrop enable quick transfers but are limited to small groups and lack persistence or organization.

Google Gemini- used to help generate marketing ideas and ensure all pain points were fixed with CIPT

“Pretend you are a 19 year old girl in a sorority, would this app help you?(document attached)” This was the most helpful, here is a direct excerpt.

If I open this app and it feels like:

- an album
- a feed I have to scroll
- or I have to “find myself”

…I’m out. Immediately.

Like no. That’s just the same problem in a different outfit.

The ONLY version of this that works for me is:

- I join with a code
- It instantly shows **only photos I’m in**

- I don’t search, I don’t scroll, I don’t think
- I just tap yes/no
- And now I know exactly what’s postable

Although the AI responses were helpful for initial feedback and ideas, they lacked specificity and in general did not truly understand the purpose of the app and how it helped. For example, when asking for help on marketing campaigns, they were generic ideas that could be used for any product launch and not specific to the group and target market dynamics we are focusing on.

However, to solve this, our group was able to clarify the product easier once it was further developed, and asked the AI to respond under a persona— which immensely improved our outputs and were able to give us clarity on what is important for the app to have.

We believe the AI was helpful for small help and ideation but the course knowledge and human experience were needed to transform those small ideas into an entire product and promotion strategy.